

Canine Communication

A complete dog training system



Handler Name: _____

Canine Name: _____

Phone Number: _____

Fundamentals Course:

Version 1

Terminology:

Reinforcers – Increase the likelihood of a behavior being repeated

Primary Reinforcer – Naturally rewarding because of it's biological need for survival *Food, Water, Love*

Secondary Reinforcer – Naturally rewarding through contributing to the acquisition of a primary reinforcer. *Chase, bark, bite*

Conditioned Stimulus / Marker – A previous neutral stimulus that has been paired with another stimulus with classical conditioning and promotes the same involuntary response in the animal as the unconditioned stimulus. *Clicker, yes, good, no, bad*

Punishers – Decrease the likelihood of a behavior being repeated

Escape Learning – Learning an behavior to escape an unpleasant stimulus

Avoidance Learning – learning a behavior by preventing an unpleasant stimulus

Neutral Stimulus – A stimulus that produces no responses

Higher-Order Conditioning - an already-conditioned stimulus is paired with a new, neutral stimulus, which then also comes to trigger the response.

Classical Conditioning – A neutral stimulus gains properties of a reinforcer/punisher through predictive association with chosen reinforcer/punisher. Produces the same **involuntary responses**. *Assosiative learning theory*

Premack Principal – Behaviors can reinforce behaviors. *Grandma's rule*

Operant Conditioning – Learning through consequences from behavior. *Instrumental learning theory*

Operant Conditioning	Positive	Negative
Reinforcement	Giving a reinforcer. Reinforce Behaviors Force Free	Removing an aversive stimuli Reinforce Behaviors Traditional Training
Punishment	Applying an aversive stimuli Punishes behaviors Traditional Training	Remove food /fun/freedom Punishes Behaviors Force Free

Desensitization – Habitation reducing the properties of a specific aversive stimulus over time

Superstition Behaviors – When punishment/reinforcement reason is unpredictable and confuses the animal. *Untrained behaviors offered as a result*

Response – reaction to stimuli, reinforcing or punishing

Extinction – The diminishing properties of a marker/behavior

Schedule of Reinforcement:

	Response Rate	Extinction Rate
Continuous Reinforcement	Slow	Fast
Fixed Rate Reinforcement	Fast	Medium
Fixed Interval Reinforcement	Medium	Medium
Variable Ratio Reinforcement	Fast	Slow
Variable Interval Reinforcement	Fast	Slow

Typical Times To Train

	Typical State or Desired State	Practice
Early morning	Extremely Active, Lean into this don't fight it	New stuff, Highly rewarding play, Fetch, walk, tug
First Getting off work	Extremely Active, Again Lean into this	New stuff, Highly rewarding play, fetch, walk, tug
Before Dinner	Extremely Active, Dinner gets to be a jackpot reward, take advantage	New Stuff, Highly Rewarding play, fetch, walk, tug
After Dinner	Flat or flatten, we don't want dogs running around with full bellies	Place, stay, Continuation markers
Before Bed	Flat or flatten, time to chill out	Place Stay, Focus, Continuation Markers

Increasing Food Drive:

- Reduce caloric intake
- Feed only once a day
- Measure food
- Use higher rewarding food items
- Pair with secondary reinforcement behaviors

Industry thoughts on punishers

- Marked punishers are significantly more effective even at much lower intensities
- Superstitious reactive behavior can be good or bad, *I don't use superstitious training*
- **No trainer** of significance agrees with social pressure or alpha dogging
- Routines can help a dog amp up or chill out, *premack principal*

Increasing Toy Drive:

- Start with dynamic rewarding with food
- Incorporate chase and frustration games with rewarding
- Toss, Catch, Chase Food

Other Tips:

- Make it real fun, not pretend fun. If it feels like a chore, your doing it wrong
- Engage with the dog for multiple short periods is better than one long session. So even if you only have 30 seconds but the dog is right there ready to learn, then train or atleast charge the reward marker, even if it's just praise and pets
- Think of something you want to learn with the dog: disk work, nose work, tracking, protection work, puzzels, tug, focused heeling, agility, trickster, hide and seek, find my keys, grab me a beer... something cool to teach, even if it's simple, just pick one thing and get the dog used to learning

Premac Principal:

If behaviors can predict other behaviors, then behaviors can condition other behaviors. Following up an activity that is neutral to the dog with a positively rewarding behavior, will make the neutral behavior positively rewarding. One example of this is playing fetch after heeling sessions. If heeling predicts fetch, then heeling will have the same involuntary response to heeling as they do playing fetch. Another example in search and rescue is playing tug-o-war with the dog after each find. Soon searching for a person is as rewarding as playing fetch. Means that variable reinforcement schedules, while still helpful, are more forgiving for withholding rewards.

GRIZ's Markers

Name	Type	Sensory	Intensity	Operant Quadrant
Yessss	Termination Marker	Verbal Marker	High	Positive Reinforcement
Gooooood	Continuation Marker	Verbal Marker	Medium to low	Positive Reinforcement
Uh-uhhh	Correction Marker	Verbal Marker	Low	Negative Punishment
No	Punisher	Verbal Marker	Medium to high	Positive Punishment
Bang	Termination marker to remote in front	Verbal Marker	High	Positive Reinforcement
Release	Termination Marker to remote in direction I'm pointing	Verbal Marker,	High	Positive Reinforcement
Eye brow raise	Continuation Marker	Visual Marker	Usually Low	Positive reinforcement
Palm Toach	Termination Marker	Physical Marker	High	Positive Reinforcement
Spin	Termination Command to remote, corrects too far in	Command	High	Positive Reinforcement,
Through	Termination command to remote, corrects too far out	Command	High	Positive Reinforcement
Break	Termination without reward.	Verbal Marker	Low	Positive Reinforcement, but just for freedom

I have so many markers to deal with precision in movements. Classical conditioning can push my dog out of position out of anticipation. I use different markers are used to correct positions by changing reward placement.

Practicals Day 1:

0. Classic Conditioning slow burn, how's the dog react to the collar

1. Conditioning a verbal Continuation marker with a primary reinforcer:

2. Luring with termination marker

3. Conditioning verbal termination marker with primary and secondary reinforcers:

4. Impulse Control through negative punishment

5. Muzzle Drill

Homework:

Charge the markers: Find 5 situations to train the dog with negative punishment; ideas:

taking a toy away for not getting off the furniture, impulse control at doors and gates, take food/toy away for resource guarding. Record some quick notes on the good and the bad:

Choose different times of the day to engage with your dog by charging continuation/termination markers. Practice Luring the dog to positions that match the mood. Try to get the dog appropriately amped for this time of the day. While sitting on the couch watching a movie, grab a handful of treats and use continuation markers to reward chill behavior. When you're getting ready to go do something together, amp the dog up by charging a termination marker. Practice Luring Record some quick notes on the good and the bad to:

Day 2 Practicals

0. Classic Conditioning slow burn, how's the dog react to the collar

1. Use negative reinforcement through leash pressure to guide the dog forward, backwards, to a sit, to a down, to a place. Reward first with negative reinforcement and with termination marker for each

2. Use negative reinforcement to move to dog to a place and sit/down, use continuation marker to hold the dog there, reapply leash pressure to sit/down if dog gets up

3. Corrections in direction/position

4. Muzzle Drill

HW D2

Use Negative reinforcement to bring a dog to a down and chill state. Use continuation markers on variable durations to positively reinforce or hold with purely negative reinforcement.

Do we have behavior we want to stop? Based on what we've learned what would be your plan?
We'll review and discuss next time.

Day 3.

0. Classic Conditioning slow burn, how's the dog react to the collar

1. Use of higher order conditioning to teach sit, down, place

2. Engagement through distractions 1:

3. Engagement through distractions 2:

4. Engagement through distractions 3:

5. Muzzle Drill:

HW. Each day switch between positive reinforcement and negative reinforcement to teach positions. On some days use them together. Try to space out help from lure or leash pressure between command and reinforcement.

How can you apply premac principal into day to day life?

Day 4

0. Classic Conditioning slow burn, how's the dog react to the collar

1. Heeling with positive reinforcement:

2. Reward Placement

3. Heeling with negative reinforcement:

4. Corrections:

5. Muzzle Drill:

HW

Through out the house, prepare treats out of sight to do short heels from room to room

With Leash pressure, bring your dog into a heel on a walk for a brief time. Spend some time with tethering if it's hard to remember.

DAY 6

0. Classic Conditioning slow burn, how's the dog react to the collar

1. Engagement with distractions

2. Dog Theft Drill *best done with harness or agitation collar, no correction collars for this*

3. Recall with positive reinforcement / correction if ignored

4. Recall bigger distractions

5. Muzzle Drill

HW:

Recall in the house to reward events

Recall from end of line to reward events

Off leash recall Ready? If no why not, if yes where/when? Interested in E-collar add-on?

- How distracting is the environment?

- How fast is the sit/down?
- Distance/Duration of the place
- Distance / speed of the recall
- Engagement of the dog in reward event
- Resets on crate release/door opening

[illegible]

Survey Rip out and give to me on day 7:

1. Tell me what you like about the course:

2. What can I do to improve:

3. How likely are you to recommend the course? _____

4. Do you prefer force free or traditional methods and why?

5. What equipment are you keeping vs selling back?

6. Are you going considering joining the club? What do you want to see at the club meets?
Examples: Pack walks, Training with distractions, Desensitization to fear, Tracking, Trailing,
Detection, Disc work, Refresher training. *I do not practice bite sports, but we can prep for it*

7. Would you be interested in lead club meets? Requires certifying but after removes daily fee
whether I'm there or not. *If I hire more trainers they will be from club members*

8. Anything I missed
